

PRODUCT DESIGN PORTFOLIO

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Overview

Over the course of the last year, my journey in design has been marked by continuous growth, exploration, and refining of my skills. This portfolio encapsulates my endeavors from Spring 2022 onward, highlighting three pivotal design projects that stand as milestones in my professional journey. Each project offers a unique perspective, challenges faced, and solutions crafted, weaving a tapestry of my evolving design sensibilities and capabilities.

Project -1: Product Redesign:

In my first venture into product design, I chose to re-envision the ubiquitous to-go box—an item we frequently encounter but rarely critique. Driven by personal experiences and a quest to enhance usability, I embarked on a semester-long journey, applying knowledge from HSE 521. This project was more than just refining a container; it was about understanding user needs, addressing common grievances, and striving to enhance the everyday takeout experience. Through iterative design, research, and testing, I aimed to transform a simple box into an epitome of function and user-centricity.

Project -2: UX Strategy Report:

Embarking on a solo endeavor in the UX Strategy realm, I identified a pressing need in the health sector: the cumbersome nature of juggling multiple apps for individual healthcare providers, losing health records, or not having any previous health records. At its core, my project seeks to amalgamate the scattered world of health reports into a singular, cohesive platform. Envisioned as a holistic health companion, the app not only centralizes health records but also provides personalized recommendations, from diet insights to sleep analysis. Applied knowledge from TWC544. This project is a manifestation of the seamless marriage between user-centric design and the critical need for integrated healthcare solutions.

Project 3: UX Research Process:

For this academic endeavor, I delved into the intricate world of usability testing, focusing on an e-commerce platform that celebrates the allure of Indian jewelry and fashion. This project was done for GIT542. This project wasn't just about evaluating a digital interface; it was an exploration of user behaviors, preferences, and challenges, aiming to harmonize design with genuine user needs. Through heuristic evaluations, user stories, and hands-on usability testing, I sought to uncover the nuanced interactions that define a user's journey and shape their overall experience.

Project 1

Product Redesign – To go Box

Introduction:

Together with a dedicated team of three passionate individuals, we've decided to re-envision the ubiquitous to-go box. Our collective experiences highlighted a shared sentiment: the current design of this everyday item, though common, leaves much to be desired. At different times and situations, each of us had found ourselves grappling with its shortcomings, turning what should be a convenient experience into one marked by minor inconveniences. It was this shared realization and a desire for better design that drove us to tackle the challenge of redesigning the to-go box, aiming not just for functionality, but for an enhanced user experience.

Accomplishments:

The project was completed with the supervision of Dr. Jaimie McNabb in the course HSE521- methods and Tools of Human System Engineering, This project was done as a team of four; Riddhi Gondaliy, Sunali Ravella, Tejaswini Barde, and myself(Nikhitha Reddy Kalakota).

The course was completed with a grade of 97.25% with an (A+). Throughout the Human Systems Engineering course, I delved into a myriad of methods and tools that broadened my understanding of user-centric design. From observational techniques to verbal protocols, co-design strategies, and usability methods, the course equipped me with a holistic approach to designing with the end-user in mind. This knowledge has been pivotal in my design journey, enabling me to create solutions that are functional and truly resonate with the user, enhancing both usability and overall experience.

Summary and Applied Theories:

User surveys

User Persona

User Journey Maps

Digital design of Product

Final Product

User Surveys:

The goal was to gather user insights and preferences related to the design of to-go boxes. The survey included 15 participants who were mostly college students. The survey covered topics like how often people use to-go boxes, what features are important, material preferences, environmental impact, and design suggestions. Interviews were also conducted with 4 individuals to gather more qualitative data. In addition, I did observational research by having a participant use a to-go box and note their interactions and expressions.

Key findings from the survey and research:

- ◆ Most people use to-go boxes frequently for leftovers or bringing meals to work. The main considerations are food safety, leak-proof ability, and eco-friendliness.
- ◆ Cardboard and bamboo are preferred over plastic or Styrofoam. Recyclable materials are valued.
- ◆ Key features people look for are compartments, leak-proof, the ability to reheat food, and utensils included.
- ◆ There is interest in more eco-friendly materials to reduce environmental impact.
- ◆ Issues with current boxes include flimsy lids, sogginess, difficulty microwaving, and leakage.
- ◆ Suggestions for improvement focused on better sealing, compartments, durability, and eco-materials.

Overall, the survey provided useful insights into user preferences and issues with current to-go box designs. It highlighted functionality, usability, and sustainability as key areas to address in future designs. The team was able to identify needs and opportunities through their research.

User Persona:

After thorough surveys and interviews, our team diligently crafted eight distinct user personas, with each of us developing two. Central to these personas are the user goals, frustrations, and pain points. Given the tangible nature of our product, the to-go box, it was imperative to delve deep into the real-world challenges users face. By capturing these nuances, we aim to address and alleviate the primary struggles, ensuring our redesigned to-go box truly resonates with and caters to the end-user's needs.

USER PROFILE

MANJARI YENGDE



Gender : Female

Age : 26

Education : Masters's degree

Occupation : Project Coordinator at Construction Company

BIOGRAPHY

Manjari is a hardworking young professional who is always on the go. She often brings lunch from home or picks up food from restaurants to eat during her lunch break. However, she has been struggling with carrying her food around as her current to-go box is difficult to carry and often spills, causing her to make a mess.

GOALS

Manjari's primary goal is to find a to-go box that is easy to carry and will prevent her food from spilling. She wants something that is durable and can withstand her daily use. She would prefer a box that is environmentally friendly.

CHALLENGES

Manjari's biggest challenge is finding a to-go box that meets all of her needs. She has tried various boxes in the past, but they all seem to have their own set of problems. She also wants to be mindful of her carbon footprint and doesn't want to use a box that is harmful to the environment.

PERSONALITY

Manjari is a conscientious and practical individual who values efficiency and sustainability. She is open to trying new things and is willing to invest in a quality product that will make her life easier in the long run.

PERSONALITY

IntrovertExtrovert

ThinkingFeeling

JudgingPerceiving

SensingIntuition

TECHNOLOGY

Software

Social Media

“As a busy project coordinator at a construction company, Manjari needs a to-go box that is easy to carry and prevents spills. She often brings her own food from home or picks up food from restaurants during her lunch break. However, her current to-go box has no handle and often spills, causing a mess. Manjari wants a to-go box that is durable, environmentally friendly, and easy to clean. With a new to-go box that meets her needs, Manjari can enjoy her meals without worrying about spills and focus on her work with peace of mind.”



User Journey Mapping:

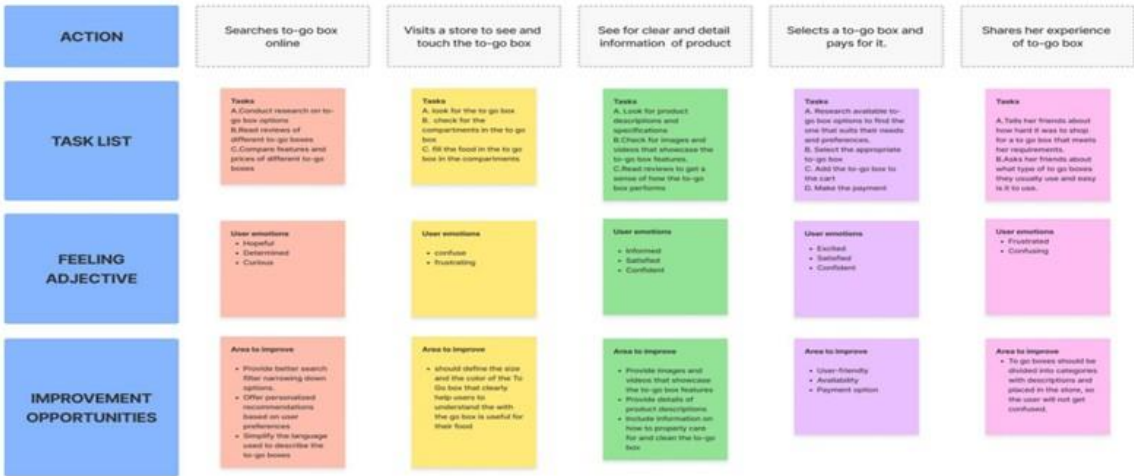
Following the establishment of our detailed user personas, we embarked on the intricate process of user journey mapping. This exercise involved tracing the step-by-step interactions and experiences a user has with the to-go box, from the moment they encounter it to its eventual disposal. Each touchpoint was scrutinized, revealing moments of delight, indifference, and frustration. The journey maps painted a vivid picture, capturing the emotional highs and lows users face throughout their engagement with the product. This comprehensive visualization allowed our team to pinpoint critical areas of improvement, illuminating potential design opportunities and areas that need rethinking. By charting out these user journeys, we've established a roadmap that guides our design refinements, ensuring the to-go box not only meets functional needs but also elevates the overall user experience at every interaction point.

Persona: Manjari Yengde

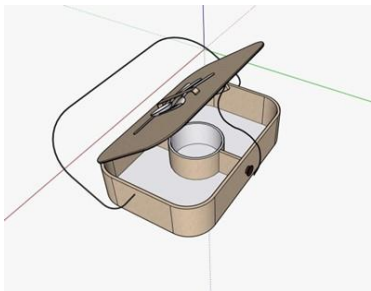
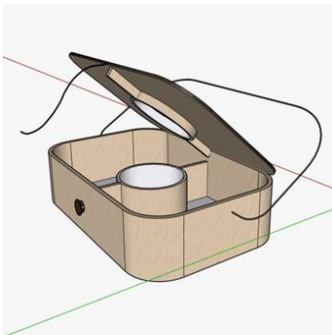
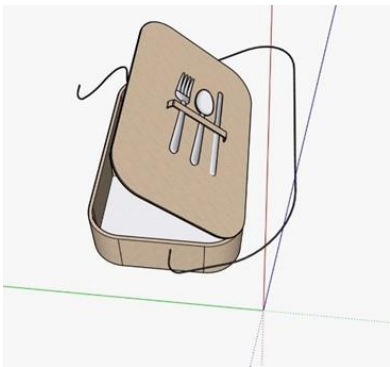
Scenario: Manjari packs her lunch in a new to-go box that she recently purchased online, and she is pleased with how easy it is to carry, and how it prevents spills, allowing her to focus on her work during lunch.

Expectations

To find a to-go box that is easy to carry, environmentally friendly, and prevents spills, allowing her to enjoy her meals without any hassle.



Digital design of the product:



Actual Product:

Top View:



Side View:



Reflection:

In this project, we noticed people were facing issues while carrying the to-go box such as, There is no handle to carry, wet or liquid items having to be carried in different containers, cutlery having to be carried separately, non-microwaveable boxes, non-eco-friendly materials, leakage or spillage of food.

Our redesign sought to directly address these issues, by using a variety of sustainable materials to create our eco-friendly to-go box. The cardboard box is composed of recyclable and biodegradable cardboard, a popular choice for environmentally responsible packaging. Bagasse, a byproduct of sugarcane production, is used to make the leak proof compartment, which is strong, microwave-safe, and biodegradable. We picked silicone for a to-go box handle, as that would give a safe, long-lasting, and environmentally responsible choice for consumers who wish to microwave their to-go box. Our new prototype of the to-go box has three sections designed to contain different types of food items. This makes it easy to keep the food separate and prevents taste mingling. A leak proof compartment in the middle that can hold liquids and is leakproof. The eco-friendly

handle is nice to touch and makes carrying the to-go box simple. Integrated cutlery within the to-go box to make it easier for the users.

These modifications are a testament to our commitment to a user-focused design approach. Through rigorous testing and research, we identified primary user concerns and took iterative steps in the prototype's development to cater to these findings. This methodology, centered around the user's experience and needs, ensures that the end product isn't just functional but optimally user-friendly. The finalized to-go box stands as a model of thoughtful design prioritizing user convenience, utility, and overall satisfaction.

Project 2

UX Strategy Report

Introduction:

In the landscape of digital interaction, understanding and optimizing the user's experience is paramount. My journey through the realm of UX design has been both transformative and enlightening, particularly due to the TWC544 User Experience course I undertook. As a significant milestone in this course, I crafted a UX strategy report, a project that synthesized the myriad lessons and principles I had absorbed. This report encapsulates the culmination of learnings from the course, where I delved deep into concepts like usability in everyday life, web design, heuristic evaluation, personas, and much more. This course was not merely a theoretical dive into the world of UX; it was an immersive experience that honed my practical skills.

Accomplishments:

For this project, my goal was to design an intuitive and user-friendly health data management app called Health Track. The report documents my UX process from initial strategy to high-fidelity designs. The app's main purpose is to give users a comprehensive platform for securely storing and managing their health data, as well as individualized insights and suggestions for health improvements.

The course was completed with a 95% or with an A grade, the final remarks of Dr. Lynne Cooke about the strategy report were "You've got an excellent UX Strategy Report. You've got an excellent idea and I truly wish there were an app like this on the market!"

Summary and Applied Theories:

I'll break down my UX approach for this app into the five planes of Jesse James Garrett's product development process in the following sections: strategy, scope, structure, skeleton, and surface.

Introduction: In today's fast-paced world, it is increasingly important to keep track of one's health and fitness. However, with so much information available, it can be overwhelming and difficult to manage. As a UX designer, I am passionate about developing user-friendly apps that simplify complicated processes, which is why I opted to work on a health data management app (HEALTH TRACK). The app's main purpose is to give users a comprehensive platform for securely storing and managing their health data, as well as individualized insights and suggestions for health improvements. This app's goal is to give users a simple and effective method to track and manage their health data

Strategy:

The concept for Health Track originated from a friend's struggle to access medical records as an international student. This experience revealed a broader issue—health data lives in silos across providers, making access and management difficult for consumers.

The app aims to be a secure, comprehensive platform where users can aggregate all their records, test results, and vital data in one place. With this consolidated view, Health Track will provide personalized insights and health recommendations tailored to each individual using cutting-edge analytics. This will empower people to take control of managing their health, addressing the problems of fragmented, inaccessible data and lack of customized guidance that many currently face.

In summary, Health Track will be a centralized health data hub that uses personalized analytics to give users actionable, tailored health advice. This solves real issues around the spread of data across systems and generic, one-size-fits-all recommendations that leave many individuals unsure how to improve their health.

Scope: The scope of the Health Track app is to offer users a platform for securely storing and managing their health data, as well as tailored insights and recommendations for health improvements. The app will contain capabilities such as tracking daily activities, monitoring vital signs, and entering medical information. Users will be able to view their data at any time and from any location, as well as securely share it with healthcare experts as needed.

Key features:

User Profile:

- ◆ Users can create a personal profile with health history, goals, and preferences.
- ◆ Enables personalized recommendations based on user data.

Data Input:

- ◆ Users input vital signs, medication info, weight, labs, and other health data.
- ◆ Data securely stored and made easily accessible.

Health Insights:

- ◆ The app provides customized health suggestions based on user's data.
- ◆ Insights cover diet, exercise, appointments, preventive care, etc.

Reminders:

- ◆ Users can set medication, appointment, and other health reminders.
- ◆ Reminders help users stay on track with health goals.

Integrations:

- ◆ The app integrates with wearables, trackers, and other health apps.
- ◆ Allows easy data import for complete view of user's health.

Data Sharing:

- ◆ Users can securely share health data with providers and trusted parties.
- ◆ Maintains privacy while enabling care coordination.

Support:

- ◆ In-app access to FAQs, user forums, and customer care.
- ◆ Helps users troubleshoot issues and learn about the app.

Structure:

The structure of UI (User Interaction) and IA (Information Architecture) are as follows:)

UI and IA are two critical structural components of any app or website.

- ◆ Users will engage with the Health Track app through a wide range of actions, including signing up, entering personal health data, accessing insights and suggestions, and adjusting their profile settings.
- ◆ A dashboard feature is added to the home page, A user may interact with the dashboard by selecting different health parameters to examine their previous data, such as blood pressure or cholesterol levels. They may also define goals for these measures and monitor their progress toward those goals.
- ◆ When a user chooses the doctor visit scheduling function, they are provided with a calendar view in which they may choose a day and time for their appointment. The app will then prompt users to provide any further information required, such as the reason for the appointment or their insurance details. The user will receive a confirmation message after the appointment has been set.

The health data management app's information architecture is critical for ensuring that the app is simple to use and navigate. It includes organizing, naming, adding, and uploading the app's content in order to give users a consistent experience.

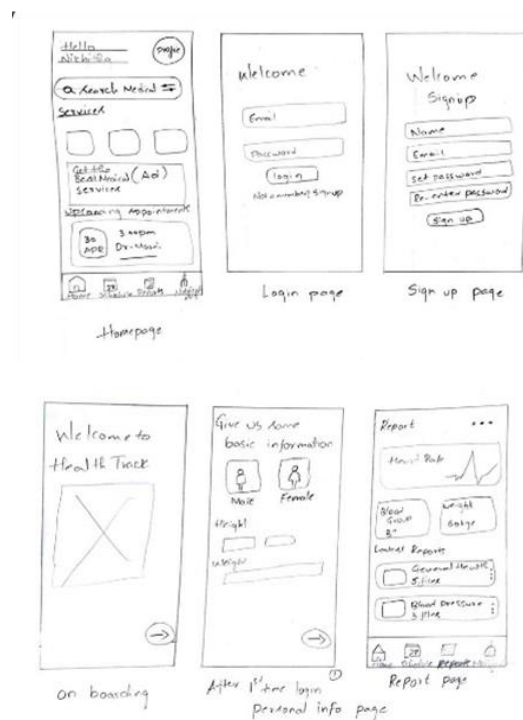
- ◆ The user will move from one screen to another. The home page will have a navigation bar at the bottom of the screen which includes home, schedule, reports, and notifications features.
- ◆ Users can access their profile which contains all of their personal information and preferences such as age, height, weight, and settings where they can allow permission to share their records.
- ◆ Users can access their records or upload new records from the records icon on the home screen. Reports like lab results, prescriptions, health history, etc. can be added to the records manually (uploading images of the reports, or adding records from the cloud or drive) or can be integrated from different apps.

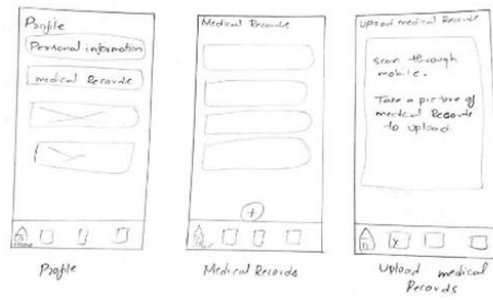
A search bar is provided on the home screen to make it easier for users to find what they are looking for.

Skeleton:

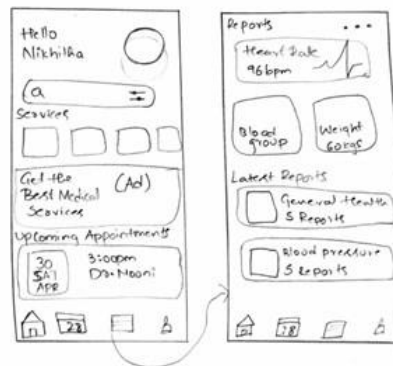
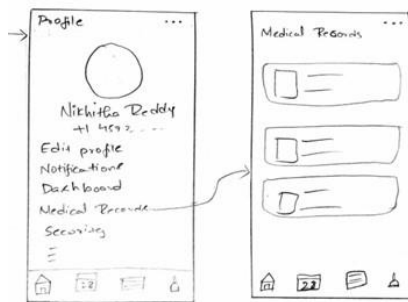
I began the design process by sketching out the thoughts that I had on pen and paper.

Low fidelity Wireframes:



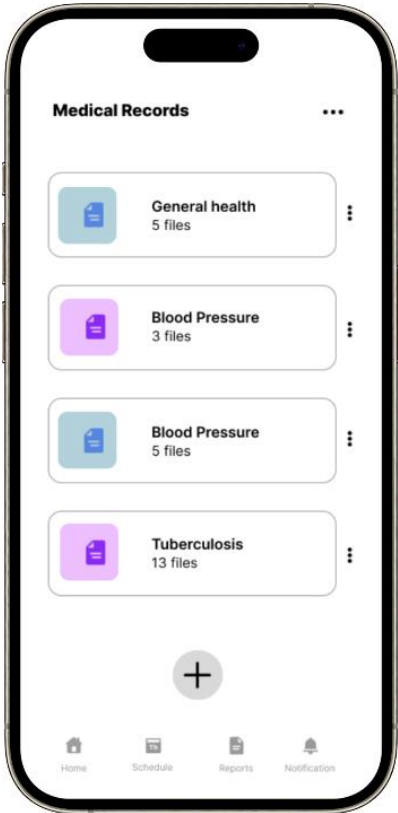
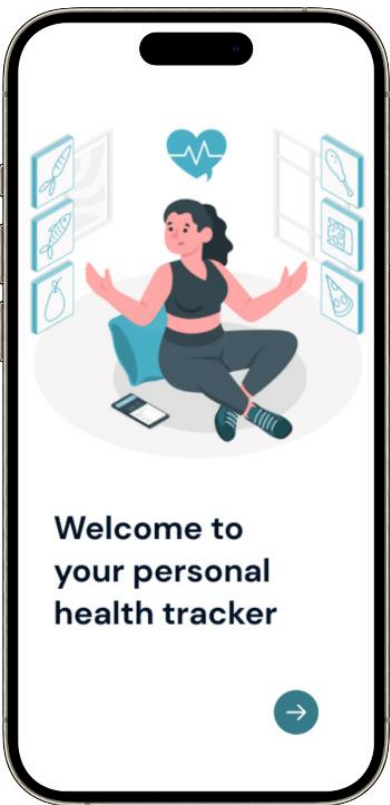
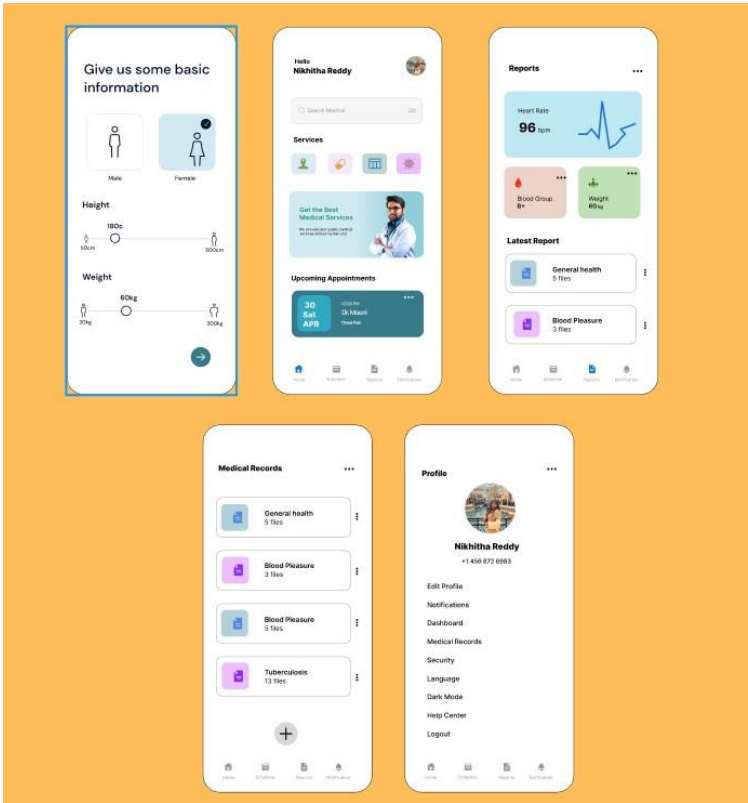


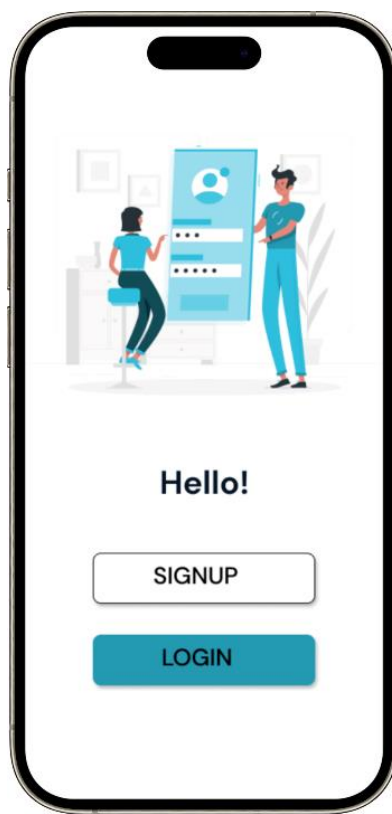
Interactions on the app:



Surface:

High-fidelity wireframes:





Reflection:

As an international student, navigating the TWC544 User Experience course was both a challenge and an enriching experience. Coming from a distinct cultural background, I carried with me a unique perspective on how design and user experience manifest across various regions. This perspective, coupled with the course's comprehensive curriculum, not only honed my skills in UX design but also emphasized the importance of crafting universal digital experiences. The journey underscored the confluence of diverse cultures and user experiences, teaching me to blend my own experiences with global design principles to create inclusive digital platforms.

I want to see this app on the market as Dr. Lynne Cooke has said, it helps a lot to many people, to maintain and store all their health records in one place. This idea stroke me when a friend of mine had issues collecting her medical reports from India to showcase them to the doctors in the US, unlike the USA, India doesn't have digitalized reports that'll be given to the patients, or sometimes the reports are held within the hospital if they are covered by insurance companies, thus it leads to no data of medical reports with the users.

Cultural and regional differences hold paramount significance in the realm of design. Each culture and region boasts its unique set of aesthetics, symbolism, and values, which deeply influence how designs are perceived and interacted with. As a designer, it's not just about creating visually appealing interfaces; it's about crafting experiences that resonate with a diverse audience, considering their cultural and regional contexts.

Project 3

UX Research Process

Introduction:

During my time in the GIT542 course, I embarked on a comprehensive UX research project, focusing on an e-commerce platform owned by a close friend. This website offers a curated selection of fashion and ethnic Indian jewelry, clothing, and other unique artifacts. Recognizing the potential and niche appeal of the platform, I dove deep into evaluating its user experience, aiming to uncover insights that could optimize navigation, enhance user engagement, and ultimately drive sales. This project presented a unique opportunity to merge my academic learning with a real-world application, emphasizing the intricacies and nuances of crafting a user-friendly digital shopping experience for culturally rich products.

Accomplishments:

In this project, my primary objective was to gain insights into the user experience of the website and work towards its enhancement. This endeavor proved to be a significant challenge, leading me to acquire new skills such as conducting heuristic evaluations, crafting user stories, and more. Through the GIT542 course, I acquired a wealth of knowledge in UX research, gaining valuable insights into improving user experiences and honing my proficiency in the field.

Summary and Applied Theories:

Heuristic Evaluation

User Research/Surveys

User Persona

User Stories

Usability testing

Prototypes

Recommendations

Heuristic Evaluation:

The Website Blush and bones is an Ecommerce website. Where you can buy clothes and jewelry, which are delivered all over india. Here, you'll discover a curated collection of fashion-forward yet authentically rooted Indian jewelry, clothing, and accessories. (<https://blushandbones.com/>) will be evaluated by the 10 usability heuristics created by Jakob Nielsen. Here are the 10 heuristics :

1. Visibility of system status.
2. Match between the system & the real world
3. User Control and Freedom
4. Consistency & Standards
5. Error prevention
6. Recognition rather than recall
7. Flexibility and efficiency of use
8. Aesthetic & minimalistic design
9. Help users recognize, diagnose, and recover from errors.
10. Help and Document

Rating Scale:

Each issue on the heuristic list will be evaluated with mplich and jeffrie's severity scale.

1. **Minor** : Delays user briefly.
2. **Serious** : Delays users significantly but eventually allows them to complete the task.
3. **Catastrophic** : prevents users from completing their task.

User Research / Surveys:

The Blush and Bones website specializes in a meticulously curated collection of both fashion-forward and classic Indian jewelry, attire, and accessories. I took the initiative to conduct in-depth user interviews and surveys. In total, I engaged with 10 individuals, meticulously noting their feedback and experiences. While all participants provided rich insights, not everyone was familiar with our specific website. For those unfamiliar, the interview questions pivoted towards understanding their general experiences and preferences when shopping on e-commerce platforms. This dual approach ensured that while we gathered specific feedback about our site, we also gained broader insights into online shopping behaviors and expectations.

The survey I designed was meticulously structured to capture comprehensive insights into the user experience. I began with a brief introduction that clarified the survey's purpose and set expectations regarding its content and duration. This was followed by a section that collected basic demographic details, such as age, gender, location, and frequency of shopping online. Then, we discerned participants' familiarity with our e-commerce site, effectively distinguishing between novice users, occasional visitors, and regular shoppers. For those unfamiliar with this specific website, I centered my questions around their general experiences with online shopping, exploring facets like website usability, payment methods, and customer service on other platforms. However, for participants acquainted with this website, I delved into detailed feedback concerning navigation, product selection, visual representation, the checkout process, and overall post-purchase satisfaction. I also integrated open-ended questions, allowing for richer, qualitative input about their experiences and suggestions. Interspersed within were rating scales on specific UX and design elements, providing a tangible, quantitative

metric for satisfaction. The survey culminated with a gesture of gratitude, thanking participants for their invaluable feedback, and offering an avenue for any final thoughts or insights.

User Persona:

Persona creation stands as a cornerstone in user experience (UX) and product design, bridging the gap between abstract data and human-centric design. By developing these fictional yet research-grounded representations, designers gain a tangible understanding of the diverse segments of their audience. In this project, this practice proved invaluable. I embarked on a journey of comprehensive user interviews, each conversation a goldmine of insights into user behaviors, preferences, and challenges.

Drawing from this rich tapestry of qualitative data, I distilled the information into three distinct personas. Each persona encapsulates a unique user archetype, informed by real-world feedback. We delved into their demographics, goals, professional contexts, and even their idiosyncrasies. These personas, now fully fleshed out, serve as constant reminders in our design process. They anchor my decisions in empathy and ensure that the solutions resonate deeply with the users they represent.



"Follow your passion"

AGE: 38
LOCATION: New Jersey
STATUS: Single
CAREER: Web Developer
University: New Haven
Hobbies: Cooking, reading, and sports

User persona

Subha Lakshmi

BIO

Subha Lakshmi is a student in New Haven University and also working as a coop on web development. She has more than 7 years of experience working as a web developer in Delhi. She wants to learn UX Design and has started to learn it by herself from youtube and udemy.

GOALS

- To become a digital UX Designer
- To Dress accordingly to school and office
- Wardrobes should have style tips to help people
- 3D tool with AR, more no of collections/ outfits. Add a few Indian wear too
- Every products description with color and other details should be there, so it wont cause any confusion

MOTIVATIONS

To discover the best design startups all over the globe and to get to know its founders, team and products.

FRUSTRATIONS

- Not finding the right size of jewelry
- Products not getting shipped properly.
- Indian jewelry and fashion jewelry to be packed separately.
- Payment issues.

PERSONALITY

Innovative: 10% Futuristic: 90%

Analytical: 50% Creative: 50%

Daily: 10% Time Rich: 90%

Messy: 10% Organized: 90%



"The smarter you get the more you spend"

AGE: 34
LOCATION: Florida
STATUS: Married
CAREER: Big data developer
University: ITKongkar
Hobbies: Dancing, Cooking

User persona

Deekshitha Madhupathi

BIO

Deekshitha is a self - made woman, she studied and worked very hard to achieve what she has today. Has over 5 years of experience, has 3 beautiful children, loves to cook and dance. She always wants her kids to be dressed differently and cute, as she herself shops a lot.

GOALS

- To be a role model for her kids.
- To be more like a friend to her kids than a mother.
- Her kids must look unique to others, in terms of dressing, studies, etc
- Customer feedback for all items is appreciated.
- Customer service should be provided. An easy and simple website with no downtime.

MOTIVATIONS

Providing a great future for my kids is the only thing that keeps me motivated to work.

FRUSTRATIONS

- Checkout and shipping issues.
- Waking up every day and cooking food, attending meetings, and satisfying everyone's needs is hectic.
- Managing three kids is frustrating
- Customer care which doesn't respond properly

PERSONALITY

Innovative: 10% Futuristic: 90%

Analytical: 50% Creative: 50%

Daily: 10% Time Rich: 90%

Messy: 10% Organized: 90%

User Stories:

DEEKSHITHA MADHUPATHI:

User Stories

- As a User I want to have Customer feedback for all the products so that I can get to know the pros and cons of the product.
- As a User I want to have proper customer service so that I can contact them whenever there's a problem.
- As a User I want to have proper links and information so that I can go to that site and see for information.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA:

As a User I want to have Customer feedback for all the products so that I can get to know the pros and cons of the product.

- Can give points or rewards for giving reviews and feedback.
- In this way people will tend to review more and it will be useful for future references.

As a User I want to have proper customer service so that I can contact them whenever there's a problem.

- Providing customer service number and available timings.
- Providing an online customer service via chat

As a User I want to have proper links and information so that I can go to that site and see for information.

- Providing properly linked redirected pages
- Making sure all of the buttons are properly linked
- Make sure all the pages have relevant information.

SUBHA LAKSHMI:

User Stories

- As a User I want to have blog or style tips so that I can choose outfits or styles from that.
- As a User I want to look at the product view so that I can check if the items suit me or not without purchasing them.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA:

As a User I want to have style tips or outfit inspiration so that I can choose outfits or styles from that.

- A "Blog or Tips" section can be added.
- A page with fashion influencers and their outfit information can be added.
- A page with new complete outfits which are linked to website can be added.

As a User I want to look at the product view so that I can check if the items suit me or not without purchasing them.

- An AR view can be added
- A detailed product review can be added by the owner of the website with original pictures.
- Adding videos of the product.

Usability Testing:

Materials:

Explanation Write-up: Pinpointed issues using diverse research techniques.

Test Plan Dashboard: Structured tests, including essential tester and website details.

Consent Form: Used a standard form, ensuring participant understanding and agreement.

Pre-test Questionnaire: Captured user demographics and site-related expectations.

Scenarios/Tasks: Deployed three scenarios, each containing two related tasks for testing.

Post-test Questionnaire: Evaluated participants' site experience after task completion.

Script: Guided participants with a structured narrative throughout the test.

Observation Sheet: Recorded real-time user behaviors and feedback during tasks.

Scenarios/Tasks:

Usability testing materials

Explanation Write-up:

From the previous stages of the design process I identified a few problems in the blushandbones.com website. Heuristic evaluation, user research, user persona and user stories helped uncover opportunities to improve the usability by Learning about the target user's behavior and preferences. Following are the

1. Finding products easily without redundancy or unwanted product suggestions.

I choose this issue as it was raised by the current users when interviewed, during user research. Since using the search function is a fundamental part of viewing our site, everyone does. I'd like to examine search engine optimization. Current user's have also mentioned that the search is not relevant.

2. Identifying any problems or particular reasons to believe the website.

eliciting from users the reasons for their faith in a website I selected this problem since both user research and heuristic assessment brought it up. Before making a purchase on a website, everyone, whether a new or returning consumer, checks the feedback or customer reviews. Additionally, customers frequently visit the website's other social media pages. Users have an extremely difficult time locating any other social media platforms for the website. Similar to how any other client would research an item before buying it to consider the quality.

3. In heuristic analysis, All buttons are not correctly connected, which is a problem I discovered. A few

buttons are inactive. And some open blank pages. When a new visitor first visits a website, they browse it, and it may not feel good to come across some buttons that are inactive.

[illegible]

TASKS		WHAT PARTICIPANT'S FINISHED THE TASK?										HOW LONG DID THE TASK TAKE TO COMPLETE? (in linear seconds, for instance: 65 instead of 1 min 05 seconds)												
ID	Task	p1	p2	p3	p4	p5	p6	p7	p8	p9	p10	Count	Success rate	t1	t2	t3	t4	t5	t6	t7	t8	t9	t10	Average
1	Use the https://blushandbones.com/ website to add an accessory to the cart that you need.	1	1	1	1	1						5	100.00%	240	300	190	320	200						250.00
2	Buy rings from this website.	1	1	1	1	1						5	100.00%	200	340	120	150	120						186.00
3	Use the search bar and sort/filters to find the products.	1		1	1							3	60.00%	380		300	385							348.33
4	Look for how long it takes for delivery.																							
5	Look up the process for working out this scenario	1	1	1		1						4	80.00%	60	85	70		75						72.50
6	Contact customer service																							
7	Submit a complaint on the website	1	1	1	1	1						5	100.00%	285	300	280	350	295						298.00
8	Find Rings under Rs.100.	1	1	1	1	1						5	100.00%	240	275	200	280	370						273.00
9	Look for customer reviews and add a product to the cart			1		1						2	40.00%			300		460						380.00
10																								

SOLUTIONS																								
SOLUTION IDEAS		ISSUES ADDRESSED BY THE SOLUTION IDEA																				ISSUE DESCRIPTIONS		
ID	Solution idea	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	ID	Description	Severity
1	smart and non-redundant search	1	1																			1	Search redundancy has occurred	3.00
2	Adding filter/sort	1		1	1																	2	Redundant search result	3.00
3	Providing correct and transparent policies					1	1															3	There was no filter sort option	3.00
4	Providing proper information in blogs and linking all the pages							1														4	Too much information in returns policy	2.00
5	Customer service agents		1	1	1																	5	Was difficult because there was no sort option	2.00
6	Points for feedback							1														6	There was no information of how long is the estimated delivery be	2.00
7																						7	no proper reviews or product description	2.00
8																						8		0.00

Prototypes:

The website, I have selected an e-commerce website that sells Indian jewelry and clothes. The issues I found while doing the research and testing were

1. Major Issue: the search was redundant which gave irrelevant search results.
2. Major Issue: There were no sort/ filter options in the categories.
3. Minor issue: There was no estimated delivery time.

Solutions:

1. A search by categories function is added.

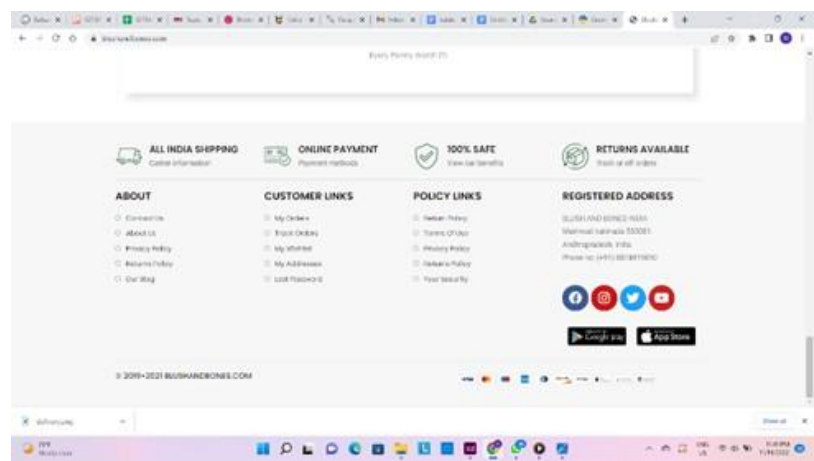


2. Socials, services, and policies weren't linked properly and led to empty pages which are resolved now by linking.

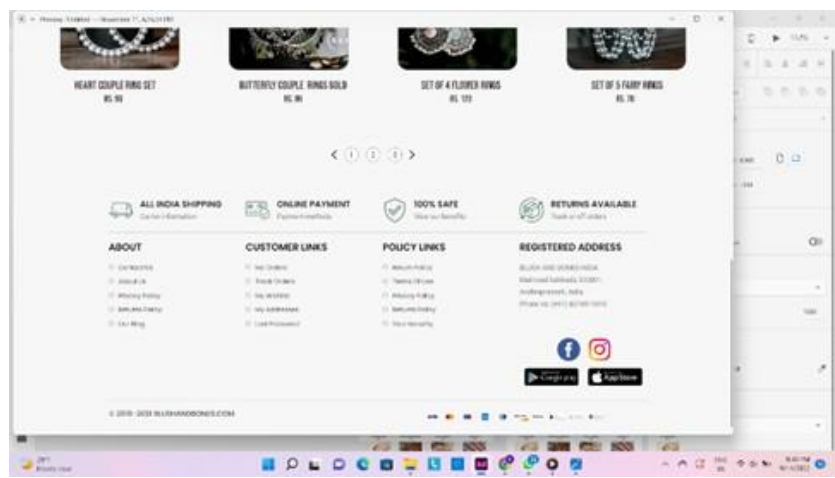
Socials included FB, Instagram, Twitter, and Pinterest. Which aren't even there, so i added only FB, and

Instagram.

BEFORE:



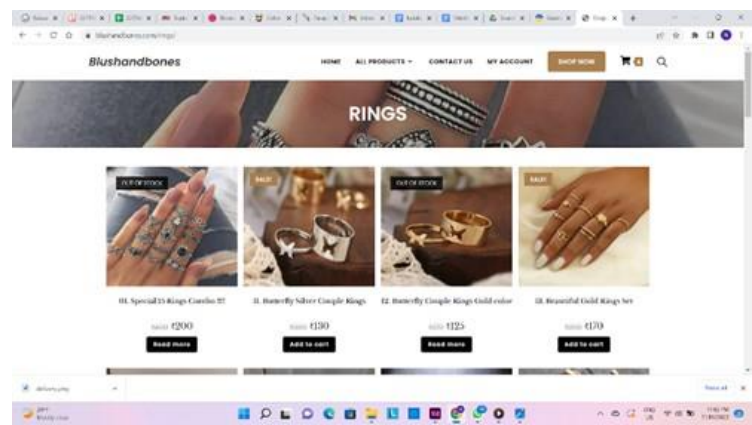
AFTER:



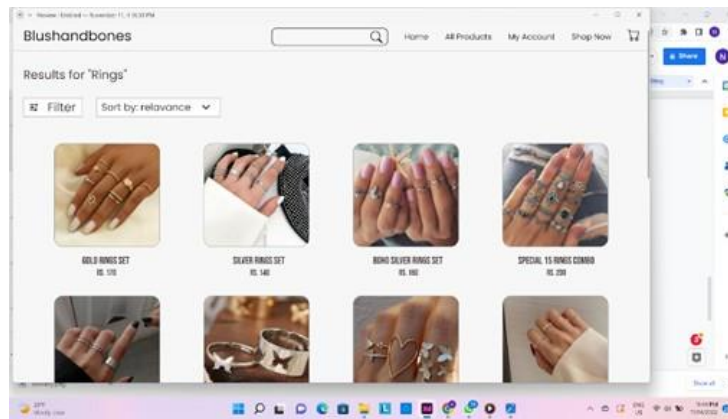
3. Added a sorting button to sort the search or categories with sort by relevance, price low to high, price high to low, popularity, and average rating.

4. Added a filter button to filter the search by price, categories, colors, sizes, and types.

BEFORE:



AFTER:



Reflection:

Engaging with an e-commerce platform, particularly one celebrating the vibrant tapestry of Indian jewelry, fashion, and apparel, was a profound learning experience for my academic journey. Among the methodologies I adopted, heuristic evaluation, user stories, and usability testing stood out as particularly enlightening. Prior to this, these were uncharted territories for me. The heuristic evaluation was a revelation; it offered a structured approach to assess the website's usability, revealing both its strengths and areas demanding attention. Crafting user stories, on the other hand, was like stepping into the shoes of the users, and understanding their aspirations, needs, and challenges.

But it was the process of usability testing that truly captivated me. Witnessing real users navigate the site, confronting barriers, and expressing genuine emotions underscored the value of such hands-on evaluations. Utilizing the Usability Testing Management Tool further streamlined this process, allowing me to gather, analyze, and derive actionable insights with precision.

The culmination of these efforts was the series of recommendations and enhancements proposed for the website. What I once perceived as a mere design exercise transformed into a lesson on the intricate dance between users and digital platforms. This project emphasized the pivotal role usability testing plays in shaping digital experiences. It's not just about aesthetics or functionality; it's about creating a harmonious space where users feel understood, valued, and empowered. As I reflect on this journey, I'm filled with gratitude for the insights gained and am more resolved than ever to champion user-centric designs in my future endeavors.

Final Reflection:

My academic journey into the enormous realm of design and user experience has been nothing short of transformative. Each course and lecture has been like a brushstroke on my understanding canvas, producing a complete image of the world of design. Understanding design concepts served as the fundamental base from the start. I was exposed to the fundamental principles that underpin aesthetic appeal, functionality, and user-centricity. It taught me to appreciate the delicate balance between form and function, as well as the rigorous attention necessary to develop visually appealing and intuitive designs.

I learned about the flexibility of design across many platforms by delving into cross-media design. The versatility and flexibility of design became clear when it moved from the static world of print to the dynamic world of digital. It emphasized the need to curate experiences that are consistent while yet being personalized to each media. My experience with heuristic assessment and usability testing demonstrated the vital relevance of iterative design. It's one thing to imagine a design, but it's quite another to see it in motion, to evaluate its strengths and limitations. These techniques highlighted the idea that designs are living entities that change in response to input and user engagement.

Human cognition, human system engineering, and human psychology courses were especially informative. They bridged the gap between abstract design principles and practical human contact. I discovered that at the center of every design is a human being, complete with complicated cognitive processes, emotions, and prejudices. Understanding these complexities is critical to creating experiences that have a deep and lasting impact.

The insights I gained from this course were greatly augmented by collaborative learning. Working in groups and with a varied set of students adds complexity to the academic experience. Each person contributed an individual perspective, a different approach to problem-solving, and their own set of talents and experiences to the table. This mash-up of ideas was both challenging and instructive, forcing me to look at situations from new perspectives and propose solutions I would not have considered otherwise.

Each course I enrolled in was thoughtfully planned, combining academic understanding with practical application. This combination guaranteed that, while I was learning the fundamentals, I was also given the means to apply that knowledge in real-world circumstances. The information was handpicked to represent both time-tested design principles and current design trends, keeping it relevant and forward-thinking. The level of my lecturers was probably one of the most notable aspects of my scholastic path. Each of them was not only well-educated in their disciplines, but also had a lot of experience, contributing stories, case studies, and real-world examples to augment our learning. Their breadth of knowledge converted even the most difficult ideas into easily consumable and enjoyable teachings. Promoting critical thinking, and developing us into well-rounded professionals. This academic experience was genuinely transforming due to the caliber of their teaching approaches and their persistent dedication to student achievement.

Finally, the emphasis on research reinforced the notion that design is more than just creativity; it is profoundly founded in facts, data, and constant learning. It is all about asking the appropriate questions, obtaining answers, and then transforming those insights into practical design solutions.

When I think back on my path, I realize that what I've learned goes beyond textbooks and lectures. It is a comprehensive grasp of the interaction between humans and designs, creativity and logic, and aesthetics and empathy. As I continue along this road, I bring with me not only knowledge, but also a deep respect for the art and science of design and user experience.